

English in my home – Someone at the door

Unit 1c – Parcel delivery



Contents

Unit 1c

Parcel delivery – teacher's notes

Parcel delivery – learner resources

Parcel delivery – video transcript

Parcel delivery – additional resources for teachers

Parcel delivery – answers

Video

Introduction

This resource has been produced in two different formats:

- a self-access resource for learners with online activities
- this teacher's pack, including teacher's notes and worksheets to download

Overview

This resource, ***Someone at the door – Parcel delivery*** is part of Unit 1 of *English in my home*, which aims to give ESOL learners the confidence and the language to deal with situations they may encounter in their homes.

There are three units of ***English in my home***:

Unit 1 Someone at the door aims to give learners confidence and equip them with the language necessary to deal with situations where unexpected callers (e.g. an electricity meter reader) arrive at the door.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone shows how to deal with incoming phone calls from a range of people. This includes unwanted calls (e.g. marketing cold calls).

Unit 3 Something in the post features some common types of mail that people receive (e.g. a utility bill), and enables learners to understand what the text means, and to know what to do in response.

Level: Entry 2 / Access 3 in Scotland / CEF A2. The materials are designed to be flexible in terms of differentiation, and are accessible to established E2 learners and at the same time relevant to E1, as well as E3 and L1.

Structure, learning hours and delivery context

English in my home provides approximately 11 hours of learning in a classroom or self-access context through a series of three linked units. Each unit can be taught as a standalone. Here is an overview of the content of each unit. Each unit has four topics:

Unit 1: **Someone at the door** (includes films)

- Topic a: Electricity meter reading
- Topic b: Charity collection
- **Topic c: Parcel delivery (the focus of this set of resources)**
- Topic d: The neighbour

Unit 2: **Someone on the phone** (includes films)

- Topic a: Cold call
- Topic b: Wrong number
- Topic c: An emergency
- Topic d: Getting a plumber

Unit 3: **Something in the post**

- Topic a: Bank statement
- Topic b: Phone bill
- Topic c: Attempted delivery note
- Topic d: Note from a neighbour

Each of the four topics in *Someone at the door* and *Someone on the phone* features a short film. These films have been scripted specifically for the project, and involve actors. The two central characters are a married Indian couple, who have recently moved to the UK, and who are getting used to life here. Each film focuses on them in a specific scenario, such as dealing with a meter reader who arrives at their flat, or dealing with unwanted cold calls on the telephone. ESOL learners should be able to relate to the experiences of the couple.

The learner materials and teacher notes contain activities for use before, during and after watching the films. They enable the learners to notice, learn and use some of the functional language featured in the films.

Something in the post, uses semi-authentic material of the kinds that learners may receive in their home, and helps them to understand these and know what action is needed.

Most topics provide approximately 60 minutes of classroom time. Units 1 and 2 can last longer if teachers choose to use the transcripts, for example by getting the learners to act out sections of the dialogues.

Unit 1 Someone at the door: overview

The unit provides up to 4 hours of classroom time, and covers 4 topics. Each topic features a short film, commissioned by the British Council for the ESOL Nexus project, and filmed with professional actors. The films aim to show real-life situations in which ESOL learners may find themselves, and the accompanying classroom and self-study materials aim to give learners the language they need to deal with a range of household situations.

The 4 topics of *Someone at the door* are called *Electricity meter reading*, *Charity collection*, *Parcel delivery* and *The Neighbour* and can be used in any order.

Unit 1c Someone at the door: Parcel delivery – teacher's notes

Time:

Approximately 60 minutes. Timings are flexible.

Aims

- to enable learners to talk with people bringing deliveries to their home

Objectives

All learners will:

- be able to speak appropriately with a courier about a delivery to the learner's home
- raise their awareness of and ability to use *a/an* and *the*

Preparation

You will need:

- learner resources (pages 9 -12 of this document) – one copy per learner
- additional resources for teachers:
screenshots (page 13) for every pair of learners in the class. Cut these up before class.
- data projector and internet connection to show the film ***Parcel delivery***

Procedure

Set up the scene of a parcel being delivered to someone's home. Either draw a simple picture on the board or find a picture online to represent this. Pre-teach *get a delivery*, *deliver a parcel*, then get learners to ask each other:

When was the last time you got a delivery?

What was it?

Explain that the learners are going to see a film in which a courier brings a delivery to the flat of Arjun and Sunita, a young couple from India, who are living in London.

Task 1: predicting the story.

Put the learners in pairs and tell them they are going to try to predict the story that they will see in the film. Give each pair one set of cut-up pictures (from **Additional resources for teachers: screenshots** on page 13 below). You could use this for practising the present continuous tense:

- *She is ringing the doorbell etc.*

Then ask the learners to predict what they think will happen in the story and put the pictures into the correct order.

Elicit what the different groups think will happen.

First viewing: gist listening

Play the film for the learners to check to see if their guesses were correct. If your learners wish to re-order their pictures to match the film, then allow them time to do so.

Ask the learners to discuss this question in pairs, and if you feel it is necessary, play the film again.

Why does the man tell his wife to go and lie down?

Elicit group feedback.

Answer: Because the courier is bringing her (Sunita's) birthday present. He (Arjun) has presumably ordered it online. He doesn't want her to know about the present, as he wants to give it to her next week on her birthday. So he tries to hide it. (Check understanding of 'to hide').

Optional extension for stronger groups – Your aim at this stage if you have a stronger group, could be to get the learners to retell the story; how much help you provide them with, and for how long, will depend on the level and confidence of the learners. You could use the pictures as prompts, model the story bit by bit yourself, and then get the learners to practise telling the story to each other in small groups, and then to retell the story to you.

Task 2: useful phrases for talking with couriers

Explain that the film contains some useful phrases that the learners can use when someone visits their home and that these are the focus of Task 2. Tell learners to complete the task and compare their answers in pairs. Then appoint one (strong) learner to act as teacher, and conduct feedback. You will need to check understanding again of things like *confirm receipt, signature, on her behalf, let you in*. Then drill the phrases. You could encourage learners to test their partner by covering up the right-hand column and asking them to finish the phrases.

Task 3: who says what?

Ask the learners to complete Task 3 in pairs, which they should be able to do without seeing the film again. Conduct feedback, and get them to practise saying the phrases again, especially Arjun and Sunita's lines.

Task 4a: articles in the transcript

Tell learners to look at the transcript (pages 11-12). This task aims to raise the learners' awareness of articles, and can be done in either of two ways:

- as a dictation, where the learners watch the film and write in the missing articles. You could then play the film again to check, pausing after each of the 9 gapped articles to check.
- as a task where the learners try to write the words without watching the film first. Then play the film again to check, pausing after each of the 9 gapped articles to check. Note – version b of this task is considerably harder than version a, and is more suited to higher level groups.

How much you tell the learners about the rules of articles is dependent on the level of your learners. Most of the phrases here can be taught as lexical chunks, where the same article will almost always be used: *What's the name please?*; *on the first floor*; *put your signature in the box*; *Would you like a cup of tea?*

You could introduce this rule about articles: We often use *a* when we mention something for the first time and then use *the*. e.g. I have *a* parcel for you. I'll bring *the* parcel up to your flat.

If your learners would like to study the use of the articles *a* and *the* in more detail, you could use this information and interactive exercises:

<http://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/en/grammar-reference/articles-1>

<http://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/en/grammar-reference/articles-2>

Task 4b: summary of the story (using articles)

This next task encourages the learners to accurately summarise the story of the film, paying attention to the use of articles. Once the learners have completed this on their own, they can check their answers with their partner. Write the answers (including the articles) on the board, and then use the words on the board as prompts to get the learners to retell the whole story.

Task 5: acting

Put the learners into groups of 3 and encourage them to read the dialogue aloud. Then, tell them to turn the dialogue face down, and improvise a similar dialogue using the phrases from Task 3.

Extension

On the subject of deliveries to the home, you may also like to use these other lessons from *English in my home*:

- Unit 3: Something in the post** (these 4 lessons do not include video)

Refer learners to the online versions of these ESOL Nexus activities about *Parcel Delivery*:

<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/someone-door-delivery>

Unit 1c Someone at the door: Parcel delivery – learner resources



Arjun (left) and the courier (right) from Parcels Direct

Task 1: predicting the story

You will see some pictures from the film. What's happening in the pictures? Put the pictures in order. Tell the story.

Task 2: useful phrases for talking with couriers

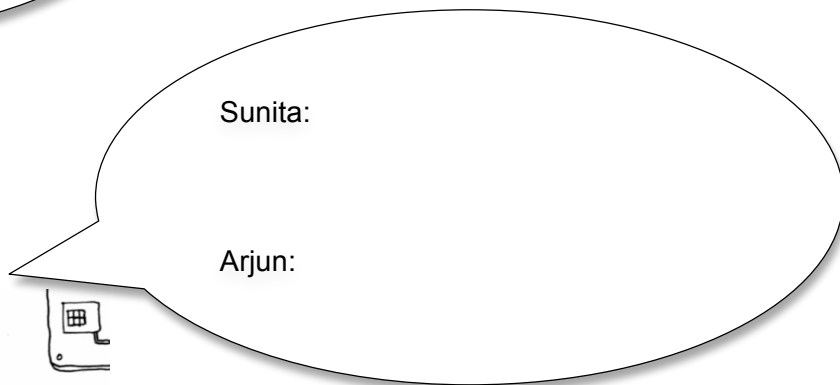
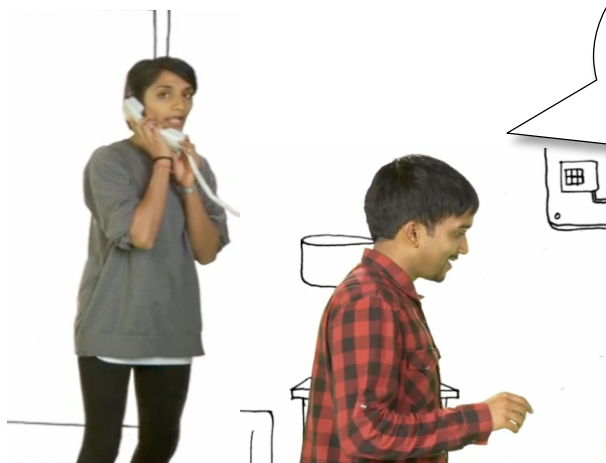
What did the people in the film say? Match 1-9 with a-i.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|------------------------|
| 1. I've got a | a. you in. |
| 2. What is the | b. you are. |
| 3. Could you bring it | c. it for her? |
| 4. I'll let | d. in the box. |
| 5. Could you sign here please to | e. name please? |
| 6. Can I sign | f. delivery for you. |
| 7. You can | g. upstairs please? |
| 8. Put your signature | h. confirm receipt? |
| 9. There | i. sign on her behalf. |

Task 3: who says what?

What does the courier say? What do Arjun and Sunita say?

Write the sentences and questions from Task 2 in the correct speech bubble.



Task 4a: articles in the transcript

Look at the transcript of the film. Write **a** or **the** in the gaps.

Wife Hello?

Courier Oh hello, it's Parcels Direct. I've got **1** _____ delivery for you.

Wife What is **2** _____ name please?

Courier Mrs Sunita Chowdry.

Wife Oh yes, that's me. We're on **3** _____ first floor. Could you bring it upstairs please?

Husband Is that a delivery? Hello. I'll let you in.

Wife How did you know? You're being very helpful today.

Husband You look tired. Maybe you should lie down.

Wife Yeah, good idea. I think I will.

(The courier knocks on the door.)

Courier Hello, I've got a delivery for you.

Husband Ah, *(loudly)* It's the electricity bill.

Courier Could you sign here please to confirm receipt?

Husband 'Confirm receipt'?

Courier To say you've got **4** _____ parcel.

Husband It's for my wife. Can I sign it for her?

Courier Yes, that's fine. You can sign on her behalf. Or **5** _____ neighbour can, if you're out. Put your signature in **6** _____ box. There you are.

Husband Thanks. *(quietly)* It's **7** _____ present for my wife actually. It's her birthday.

Courier Oh really? Today?

Husband No, next week. But I'm going to hide it!

Courier Oh, well good luck. I hope she doesn't find it!

Husband No way, she won't! Cheers.

Courier Bye. Thank you.

Wife So, what was it?

Husband Oh, nothing. Would you like **8** _____ cup of tea?

Wife No, come on, what was it?

Husband Or coffee?

Wife Come on, tell me, what was it? Give it to me! It's got my name on! It's for me! What are you doing with it?

Husband It's your birthday next week. You ask too many questions!

Wife OK, I didn't see anything. I'll make **9** _____ tea!

Task 4b: summary of the story

Complete the story with the phrases from the box.

Someone rings at the door of Arjun and Sunita's flat. It's a woman who says she's

1 _____. She says she has **2** _____ for Sunita. Sunita asks her to bring **3** _____ up to their flat on **4** _____. Arjun opens the door and lets **5** _____ in. She needs **6** _____ from Arjun (to confirm receipt), and she asks him to write his name in **7** _____ on her machine. Then she gives him **8** _____. Arjun explains that it's **9** _____ for his wife, and that her birthday is next week. He goes into **10** _____ to hide it. But Sunita comes in and finds him.

a courier	the courier	a delivery	the delivery	the parcel	the kitchen	the first floor
a birthday present		the box	a signature			

Task 5: acting

Work with 2 other learners and read the transcript aloud, acting out what happens in the film.

You could also make up your own conversation. Learner A is a courier, and has a delivery for Learners B and C. Use some of the phrases from the film.

Unit 1c – Parcel delivery. Additional resources for teachers: screenshots



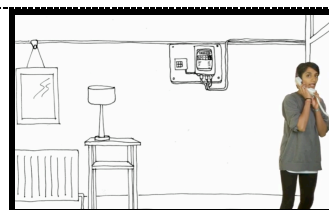
picture A



picture B



picture C



picture D



picture E



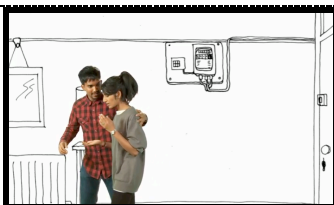
picture F



picture G



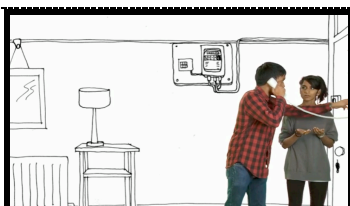
picture H



picture I



picture J



picture K



picture L

Unit 1c Someone at the door: Parcel delivery – answers**Task 1: predicting the story**

1. g
2. d
3. k
4. i
5. b
6. c
7. e
8. l
9. h
10. a
11. j
12. f

Task 2: useful phrases for talking with couriers

1. f
2. e
3. g
4. a
5. h
6. c
7. i
8. d
9. b

Task 3: who says what?**Courier:**

I've got a delivery for you.
Could you sign here please to confirm receipt?
You can sign on her behalf.
Put your signature in the box.
There you are.

Arjun and Sunita:

What is the name please? (Sunita)
Could you bring it upstairs please? (Sunita)
I'll let you in. (Arjun)
Can I sign it for her? (Arjun)

Task 4: articles in the transcript

1. a
2. the
3. the
4. the
5. a
6. the
7. a
8. a
9. the

Task 4b: articles in the summary of the story

1. a courier
2. a delivery
3. the delivery (or the parcel)
4. the first floor
5. the courier
6. a signature
7. the box
8. the parcel (or the delivery)
9. a birthday present
10. the kitchen

Unit 1c Someone at the door: 'Parcel delivery' video

The video that accompanies the activities for 'Unit 1c Someone at the door: Parcel delivery' is available to watch on the ESOL Nexus website.

